
Nenolink AI Marker

User Guide

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A practical guide to visible AI disclosure badges for images and video.

(c) Henrik Nielsen - nenolink.com

1. What Nenolink AI Marker does

Nenolink AI Marker adds a visible disclosure badge to images and videos. It supports individual images and repeatable folder batches. Originals are never intentionally overwritten; output names end in `_ai`.

The Nenolink badge system is a practical transparency system. Choose wording that accurately describes how AI was involved in the specific content or workflow.

Processing is local on the Windows computer. The application does not upload media to a cloud service and does not require login, telemetry, or analytics. Personal filesystem paths are not written into Nenolink AI Marker metadata. When automatic update checking is enabled, the application periodically contacts `nenolink.com` solely to obtain current release information; it does not send media or user content.

AI Marker metadata

Nenolink AI Marker automatically adds minimal machine-readable metadata to processed files. It identifies Nenolink AI Marker as the software, records the selected AI label, and records the marker version. This metadata complements the visible badge; the visible badge remains the primary human-readable disclosure.

Metadata is not proof of authenticity, is not tamper-proof, and does not guarantee legal or regulatory compliance. Editing software, websites, and social-media platforms may change or remove metadata. Review every processed output before publishing it and retain the original file.

Inspect File

Inspect File reads recognized Nenolink AI Marker metadata from JPEG, PNG, WebP, MP4, and MOV files. Choose a file and the result shows the filename, format, size, status, software, AI label, and marker version. Inspection is read-only and does not modify the selected file.

Found means recognized Nenolink metadata was found. **Not found** means that recognized metadata was not found; it does not mean AI was not used. Metadata may have been stripped or altered. Inspect File is not an AI detector and does not establish authenticity, provenance, certification, legal compliance, or EU AI Act compliance.

The visible badge is the human-readable disclosure. Metadata is machine-readable information. Inspect File reads that machine-readable information.

Legal notice: Nenolink AI Marker is a practical transparency and labelling tool. Its badges and documentation are not legal advice, certification, regulatory approval, or a guarantee of compliance with the EU AI Act or any other requirement. Users remain responsible for choosing appropriate disclosures, reviewing output, and complying with applicable laws, contracts, platform rules, and professional requirements. See the full Legal Notice and Disclaimer near the end of this guide.

2. Installation and first start

Extract the complete Windows ZIP to a writable folder. Keep the EXE, assets, locales, and docs together. Start `Nenolink-AI-Marker-1.0.1.exe`. Windows may show a reputation warning for an unsigned download; verify that the file came from the official Nenolink release before continuing.

The app needs no administrator rights. Settings are stored under `%APPDATA%\Nenolink\AI Marker\settings.json`, so replacing the program folder does not normally remove preferences.

The footer shows the installed version. To add convenient access without installing the application, open **Badges** and choose **Create Desktop Shortcut**. This creates `Nenolink AI Marker .lnk` on the current user's Windows desktop, pointing to the packaged EXE and using its icon. It does not move or copy the application and does not pin anything to the taskbar. If you later move the application folder, recreate the shortcut; taskbar pinning remains available through Windows' normal shortcut menu.

3. Language selection

Choose a language in the top bar. English, Danish, German, French, Spanish, Italian, Portuguese, Dutch, Swedish, Norwegian, Polish, and Czech are included. The choice is saved immediately. Missing translated text falls back to English. The product name and badge artwork do not change with the interface language.

Update checks

Automatic update checking is enabled by default and can be disabled in the Badges area. It contacts nenolink.com at most once every 30 days using a short, asynchronous HTTPS request. **Check for updates** performs a manual check regardless of that interval. The request contains the installed version and ordinary connection headers only; it does not include media, filenames, file paths, badge or logo information, licence data, or an installation identifier. Offline, timeout, server, and invalid-response failures do not prevent normal use. A newer version appears as a red link in the header and opens only Nenolink's approved update page. AI Marker does not download or install updates automatically.

4. Standard and custom badge folders

Open **Badges**. **Nenolink Standard Badges** uses the ten files bundled in `assets\bades`. To use your own badge, select **Custom Badge Folder**, choose an ordinary Windows folder containing PNG, JPG, JPEG, or WebP badge images, and click **Refresh Badges** after adding files. Transparent PNG is recommended. The app reads custom files in place and does not copy or alter them. If a saved custom folder disappears, the app reports the exact path and temporarily uses standard badges while retaining the old path for correction.

5. Selecting a badge

Select a filename from the badge menu. The same selected badge is used for the single-image preview, saved images, and every selected item in a folder batch. Refreshing preserves the selection when the file still exists.

6. Live image preview

After an image is selected, Single File shows a live, scaled preview containing the selected AI badge and, when enabled, Own Logo. Changes to either overlay's position, size, margin, and opacity appear in memory before saving; no preview operation modifies the source or writes metadata. The final Save As operation always renders from the full-resolution source. The Badges view also shows badge artwork without stretching it, with a display name and short usage description for standard badges. Transparency and aspect ratio are preserved.

7. Processing a single image

Choose **Single File**, then **Choose Image or Video**. JPG, JPEG, PNG, and WebP images are supported. Adjust placement, size, margin, and opacity and inspect the preview. Click **Save Marked Image....** The normal Windows Save As dialog proposes `originalname_ai.ext`; you may edit the name and Windows confirms before replacing an existing file. The source is not selected as the default destination and is never silently overwritten. Full-resolution originals are used for output; the preview is only a scaled display.

Optional own logo for images

Own Logo is separate from the selected AI badge. Enable it to add a PNG, JPG/JPEG, or WebP logo to the same image-processing operation, then choose its independent position, size, margin, and opacity. Transparent PNG or WebP is recommended when the logo should not have a rectangular background. The preview shows both overlays, including when they share a corner.

Own Logo is optional branding and currently applies only to single images and image files in Batch Processing. It is never used as the AI Label, its local path is not written to metadata, Inspect File does not detect it, and it is not applied to video. Source files remain unchanged. If a remembered logo disappears, logo processing is disabled while the stored path remains available for correction.

8. Processing video

Single File and batch video processing accept MP4, MOV, MKV, AVI, and WebM. Select **Permanent** to show the badge throughout, or **Beginning/End** to show it for the chosen duration (5 seconds by default). Position, size, margin, and opacity apply in every mode. **Save Marked Video...** opens the Windows Save As dialog with `originalname_ai.ext` proposed. The Windows package includes the required FFmpeg component; no separate installation or PATH configuration is needed, and it runs without a console window. Audio is copied where the output container permits it and video is encoded as H.264. Container/codecs combinations vary; review an output before publication. If FFmpeg rejects one batch file, that file is recorded as an error and the batch continues.

9. Folder batch processing

Choose **Batch Processing**, select an input folder, configure output, media, suffix, and video options, then click **Scan Folder**. Review image, video, unsupported, oversized, selected-total, and destination counts. Click **Start Batch Processing** only after the scan. Batch uses the suffix automatically (default `_ai`) and does not open one Save As dialog per file. Progress shows the current filename and success, skip, and error totals. **Cancel** stops before the next file; it does not delete completed outputs. A corrupt file does not stop later files.

10. Input and output folders

The default output is an editable AI-marked subfolder inside the input folder. Alternatively, choose a separate output folder. **Include subfolders** scans recursively. **Preserve folder structure** recreates relative folders under the destination. Existing output files are skipped, never overwritten. Output naming is `originalname_ai.ext`.

11. Position, size, margin, and opacity

Position can be top-left, top-right, bottom-left, or bottom-right. Size is a percentage of image width. Margin is measured in source pixels from the chosen edges. Opacity ranges from fully transparent to fully opaque. The app limits extreme settings so the badge remains within the media frame.

Back on Batch Processing, Badges, or Inspect File returns to Single File without resetting the selected input, badge, source, logo, or other settings. Top tabs are also navigation only. **Reset** is different: it returns to Single File and the Welcome view, clears the selected input, inspection result, and temporary batch state, selects standard AI Assisted, disables Own Logo, and restores the badge and logo defaults, Permanent video mode, 5 seconds, and `_ai`. Remembered custom badge and logo paths are retained.

12. Choosing the right standard badge

The first four badges describe broad disclosure status. The remaining six describe a media type or workflow. A badge is a concise signal, not a complete provenance record. Keep supporting information when context requires it.

13. AI Assisted

Recommended when AI contributed but a person remained substantially involved in planning, selection, editing, or authorship.

14. AI Generated

Recommended when an AI system primarily generated the content. Human prompting or selection does not by itself make the output non-generated.

15. AI Modified

Recommended when AI materially changed existing content, such as substantial inpainting, replacement, synthesis, or transformation.

16. Human Reviewed

Recommended as an additional disclosure when a person reviewed AI-related output before publication. Review does not guarantee correctness, safety, legality, or regulatory compliance.

17. AI Image

Recommended for image-specific AI generation or material modification.

18. AI Video

Recommended for video-specific AI generation or material modification.

19. AI Audio

Recommended for synthetic or materially AI-modified speech, music, sound, or other audio.

20. AI Software

Recommended when AI materially assisted production of software or source code. It is not a security or quality certification.

21. AI Translation

Recommended when AI translated content between languages. Consider human review for consequential or specialist material.

22. AI Localization

Recommended when AI helped adapt content to a locale, market, or culture beyond direct translation.

23. EU AI Act transparency background

Regulation (EU) 2024/1689, commonly called the EU AI Act, contains transparency obligations for providers and deployers of certain AI systems. Article 50 addresses, among other matters, informing people when they interact with certain AI systems, machine-readable marking of synthetic outputs by providers, and disclosure duties for certain deepfake and public-interest text uses. The exact duties, exceptions, timing, technical standards, and responsible party depend on the facts and applicable law.

Nenolink AI Marker adds a visible badge. A visible badge is not the same as every machine-readable marking or disclosure that Article 50 may require. Not every Nenolink badge is individually mandated by the EU AI Act, and using this application does not automatically ensure compliance. Consult the official regulation and qualified legal advice for your situation.

Official source: Regulation (EU) 2024/1689, Article 50, EUR-Lex:
<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX:32024R1689>

24. File compatibility and processing limits

As practical guidance, images up to 50 MB and videos up to 2 GB are recommended. These are recommendations, not guaranteed technical maximums; larger files may still work.

Not every image or video file can necessarily be processed. Compatibility and practical processing limits depend on the file format, codec, resolution, duration, file size, whether the file is damaged or corrupt, unusual encoding, available RAM, CPU performance, available disk space, and temporary processing space. Video processing also depends on whether the bundled FFmpeg component supports the file's container, codecs, and encoding.

No fixed maximum file size is defined. A file that works on one computer may fail or take substantially longer on another because practical limits depend partly on the user's computer and available resources. Keep original files and review every processed output before publication or distribution.

25. Limitations and user responsibility

You are responsible for selecting an accurate badge, obtaining rights to source media and badge artwork, reviewing outputs, retaining originals, and meeting applicable contractual, platform, accessibility, privacy, intellectual-property, consumer-protection, and AI rules. Visible overlays can be cropped or removed. The tool does not embed cryptographic provenance and does not verify whether content was made with AI.

Legal Notice and Disclaimer

Nenolink AI Marker is a software tool designed to assist users in providing transparent information about the use of artificial intelligence in digital content and production processes.

The badges, descriptions, recommendations, and documentation provided with the software constitute a practical transparency and labelling system developed by Nenolink. They do not constitute legal advice, certification, regulatory approval, or a guarantee of compliance with Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 (the EU Artificial Intelligence Act) or any other applicable law or regulation.

Not every Nenolink AI badge corresponds to a specific legal labelling requirement. Some badges are provided voluntarily to support greater transparency about how AI has been used.

The appropriate disclosure or labelling requirements depend on the content, the AI system involved, the user's role, the context in which the content is published, and applicable legislation.

Users remain responsible for determining whether and how their content must be labelled and for complying with applicable laws, contractual obligations, platform rules, and professional requirements.

References to the EU AI Act and other regulatory material are provided for general informational purposes. Legislation, regulatory guidance, and interpretations may change over time. Users should consult current official sources and, where necessary, obtain appropriate professional or legal advice.

Nenolink does not warrant that applying a badge with Nenolink AI Marker will by itself satisfy any particular legal, regulatory, or contractual disclosure requirement.

Software output should be reviewed by the user before publication or distribution.

Nenolink AI Marker must not be presented as:

- an EU-certified compliance tool;
- an automated EU AI Act compliance system;
- legal advice; or
- a guarantee that content has been correctly classified.

26. Troubleshooting

- **No badges found:** Confirm that PNG files are directly inside the folder shown in the message, then click **Refresh Badges**.
- **Custom folder missing:** Reconnect the drive or choose a replacement folder. Standard badges remain available.
- **Image will not open:** Confirm it is a valid JPG, JPEG, PNG, or WebP, not merely renamed.
- **Large or complex file fails:** Close other demanding applications, confirm sufficient RAM and free disk space, and try a smaller-resolution copy while retaining the original.
- **Damaged or unusually encoded file:** Open and re-export a copy in a common format with a trusted editor, then process the copy. Never discard the original.
- **Video fails:** Confirm that the complete application folder was extracted from the ZIP and that its bundled components remain together. The file's container or codecs may be unsupported. Very long, high-resolution, or unusually encoded videos can require substantial CPU, RAM, disk, and temporary space.
- **Processing stops or the disk fills:** Free disk space, including space used for temporary processing, then retry. Review the resulting file completely before publication or distribution.
- **PDF guide does not open:** Confirm docs\Nenolink-AI-Marker-User-Guide-EN.pdf remains beside the application structure and that Windows has a default PDF viewer.
- **Unexpected output location:** Scan again after changing input or output settings and read the displayed destination.
- **Existing output skipped:** Rename or move the existing _ai file. The application does not overwrite it.
- **Settings seem damaged:** Close the app, back up and remove %APPDATA%\Nenolink\AI Marker\settings.json; defaults are recreated on next start.

Support and attribution

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